How to Scale to $1 Million/Month (Step by Step)

Channel: Tim Luong · Published: Nov 05, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NddfYI5rZD4 Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Every revenue plateau requires a fundamentally different founder skillset. Tim Luong maps out five stages from $0 to $1M+/month, sharing personal mistakes and the specific bottleneck that breaks businesses at each level.

📑 Contents

- 🧱 The Core Framework: Your Business Scales With You
- 🌱 Stage 1: $0 → $30K/Month — Can You Find What Works?
- 📈 Stage 2: $30K → $100K/Month — Can You Understand and Sell to Your Customer?
- ⚙️ Stage 3: $100K → $300K/Month — Can You Build Repeatable Systems?
- 🏗️ Stage 4: $300K → $1M/Month — Can You Hire, Train, and Manage Talent?
- 🏛️ Stage 5: $1M+/Month — Can You Lead Leaders and Run an Organization?
- 🔑 Closing Insight: The Bottleneck Is Always You

🧱 The Core Framework: Your Business Scales With You 0:24

- Businesses consistently stall at the same revenue milestones: **$30K, $100K, $300K, and $1M/month**
  - The reason you're stuck at $100K is completely different from the reason you're stuck at $500K
  - One of founders' biggest mistakes: applying the strategy that solved the last bottleneck to the next one
- Each stage demands you become a different person as a founder:
  - $0 → $30K: Can you find solutions at all?
  - $30K → $100K: Can you understand your customer and sell to them?
  - $100K → $300K: Can you turn what works into a repeatable system?
  - $300K → $1M: Can you hire, train, and manage talented people?
  - $1M+: Can you lead leaders and manage an organization?

> "Your business scales based on your capabilities as a founder. Every stage forces you to become a different person."

🌱 Stage 1: $0 → $30K/Month — Can You Find What Works? 1:10

- This is potentially the **hardest stage** because you don't know what you don't know

    - You're randomly testing different products, messages, and acquisition channels (organic content, paid ads, cold outreach)
    - No income is coming in; you may still be employed elsewhere trying to launch simultaneously
    - Personal income is near zero while you must also spend money to set things up
- The only goal: find evidence that *something* works
    - Do NOT build a fancy website at this stage — it's a distraction
    - The only proof that matters: **can you get a customer to pull out a credit card and actually pay you?**
- Iteration speed is your biggest advantage
    - If a prospect doesn't pay, ask: was the message slightly off? Would a similar customer type close?
    - Build fast feedback loops to understand *who* wants this, *what message* resonates, and *whether* they'll pay
- Tim's personal example:
    - Tried a tech startup — didn't work
    - Tried an after-hours educational program for high school students — didn't work
    - Launched an **in-person trading education class** → generated roughly $5K–$10K in revenue in the first cohort
    - Recognized the signal, doubled down, scaled to $30K/month then eventually $100K/month
- Key principle: **do not try to optimize a business that hasn't found momentum yet**
    - The moment you get one early data point, that's when you pour energy into it

📈 Stage 2: $30K → $100K/Month — Can You Understand and Sell to Your Customer? 3:34

- At $30K something is working — but you may not fully understand *why* yet
- **Obsessively interview your early customers every week:**
    - Why did they buy from you specifically?
    - What message resonated?
    - What product improvements do they want?
    - Why did they choose you over competitors?
- Translate those answers into: